

TOWARDS A CLIENT-BASED BRAND EQUITY MODEL FOR SELECTED BUSINESS-TO-BUSINESS SERVICES

P. Steenkamp, F. J. Herbst and J.C. de Villiers

Key Concepts

- Brand defined
 - A brand resides in a consumer's mind. It is a consumer's perception (brand image) and attitude, which comprise the tangible and intangible (attributes, benefits and psychological/emotional) **associations that are used to identify and differentiate an offering** (adapted, Keller, 1993: 2-5). For a consumer a brand contains a promise of performance and value, which allow consumers to project their self-image (Keller, 2008: 8; Chiaravalle & Schenck, 2007: 34-35).

Key Concepts

- Brand management
 - The **process** of managing an organisation as a brand and an organisation's brand(s) in order **to preserve and enhance brand equity** (Interbrand, 2007: 17)
- B2C vs. B2B
- Product vs. service
- Individual brand vs. organisation brand

Research Problem

- There is no comprehensive and accepted brand equity model for B2B services
 - Generic B2C branding model used for B2B services
 - May lead to suboptimum brand building strategies

Conceptual Question

- What does research literature tell us about brand equity, branding models and B2B services branding?

Key Branding Models

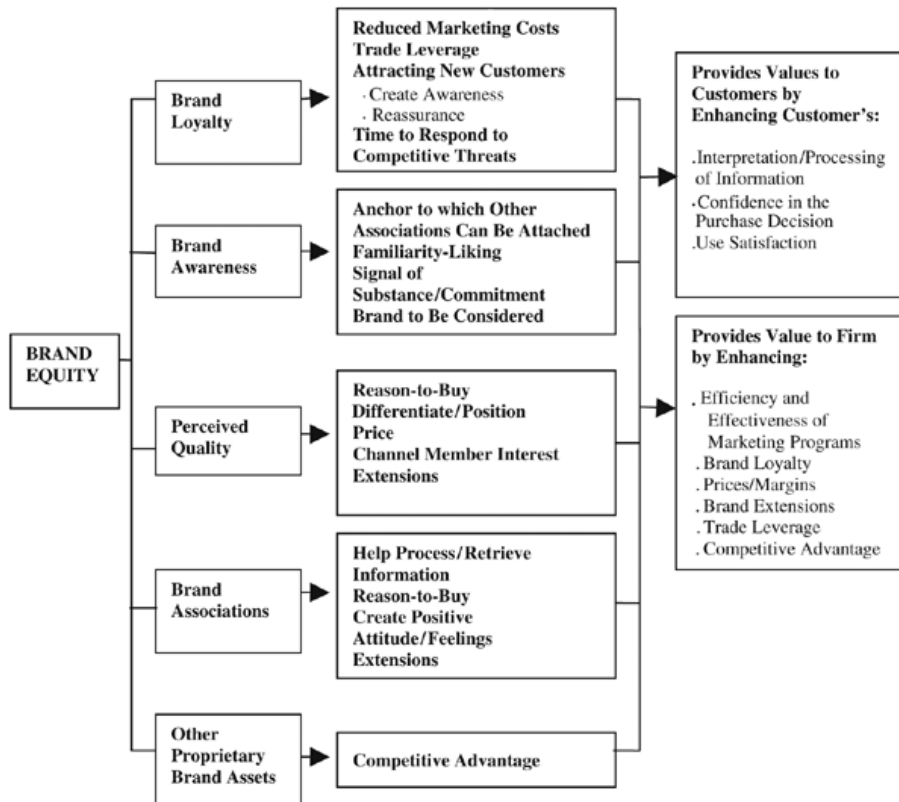


Figure 1: Aaker's brand equity model

Source: Aaker (1991: 270)

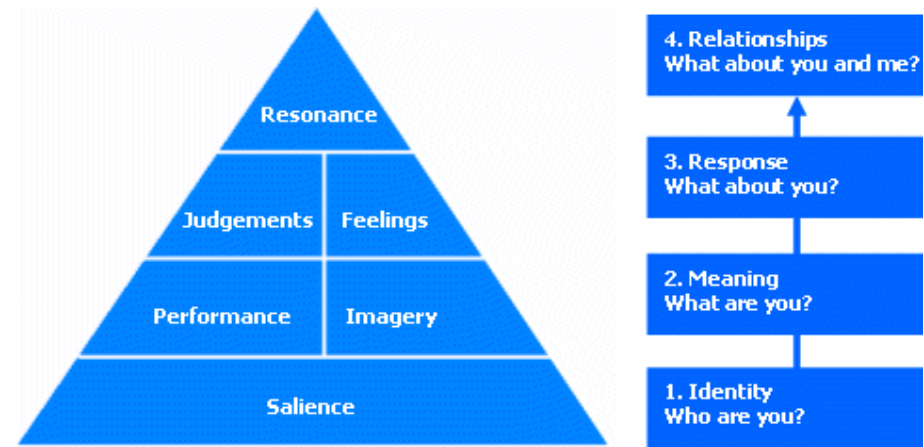


Figure 2: Keller's customer-based brand equity model

Source: Keller (2008: 60)

Key Branding Models

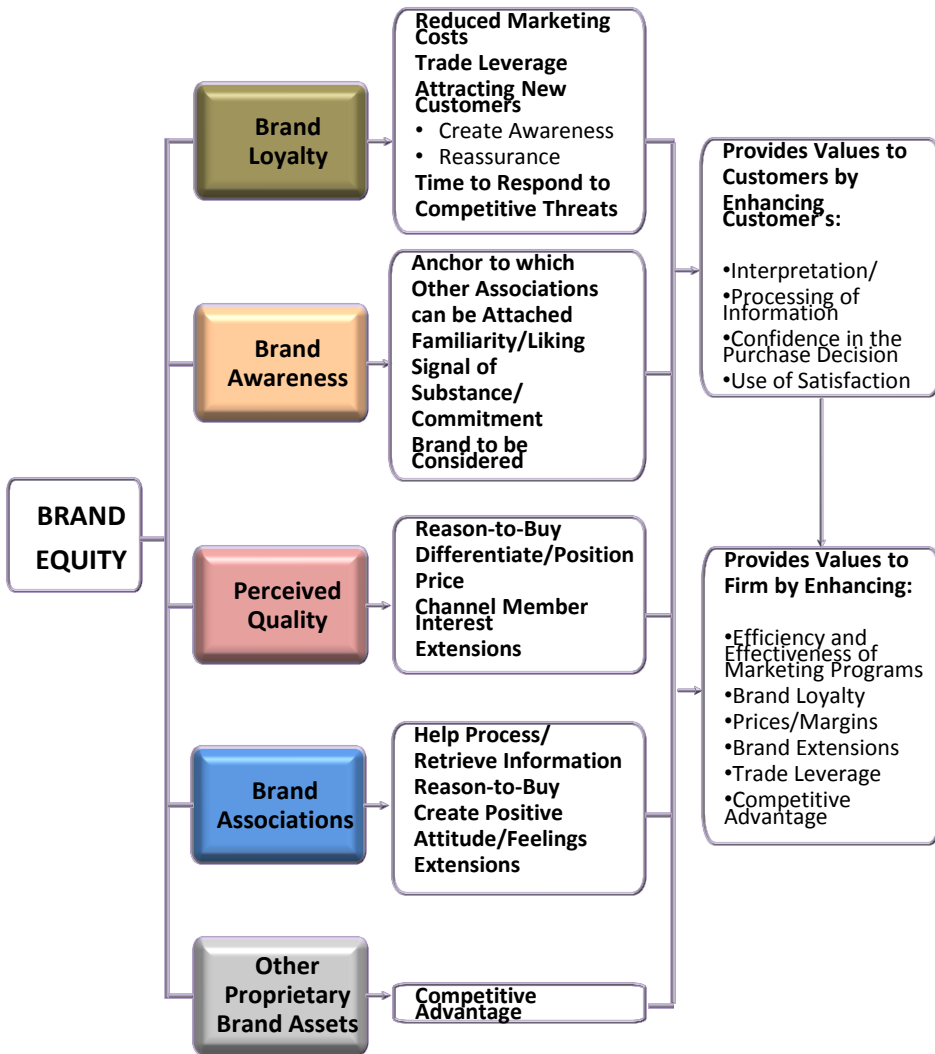


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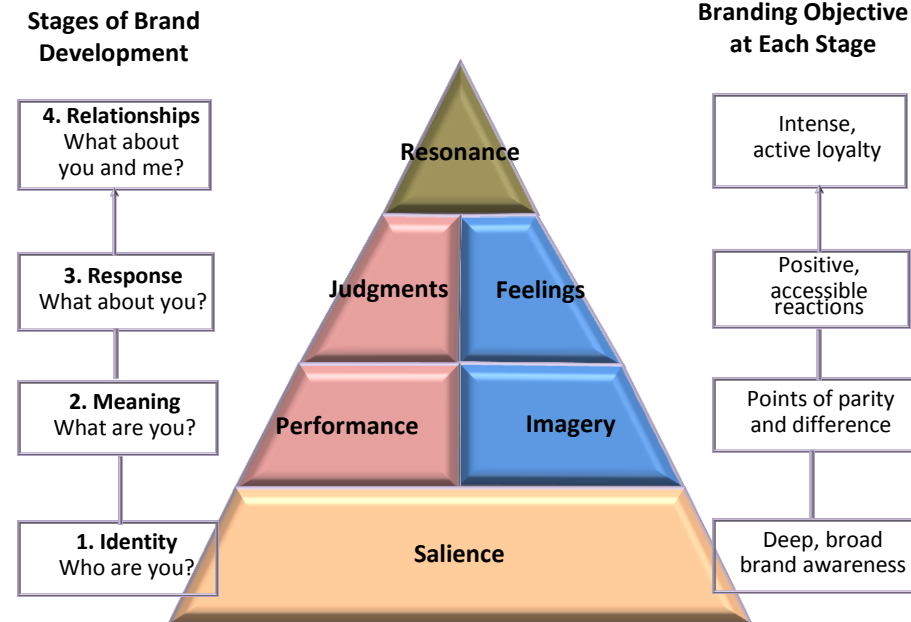


Figure 2: Keller's customer-based brand equity pyramid

Source: Keller (2001: 17)

Key Branding Models

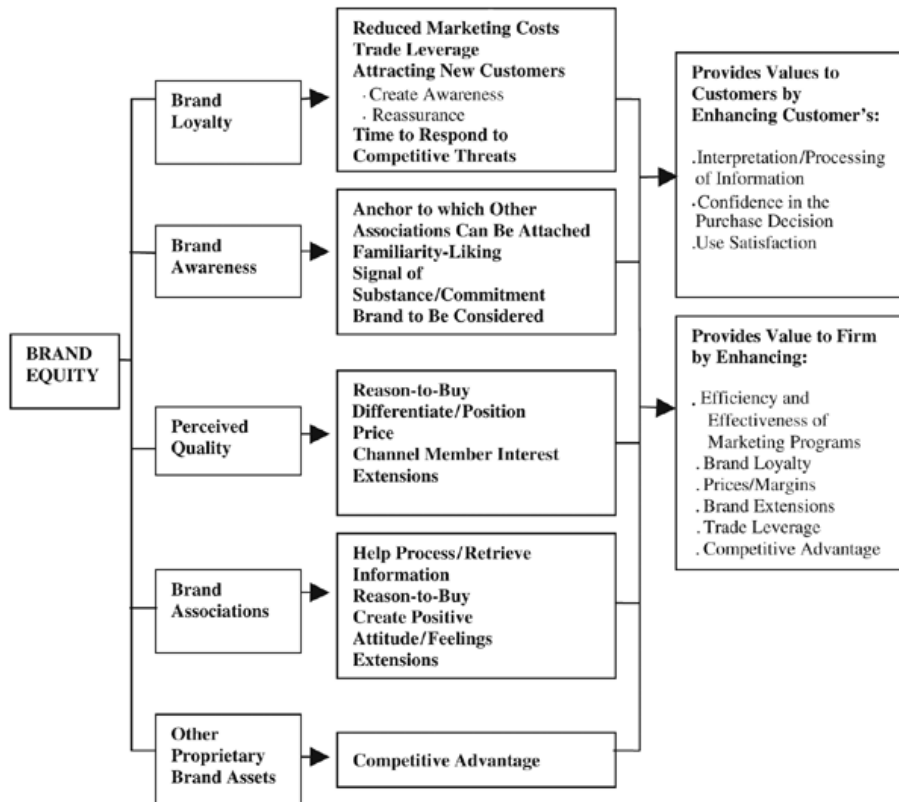


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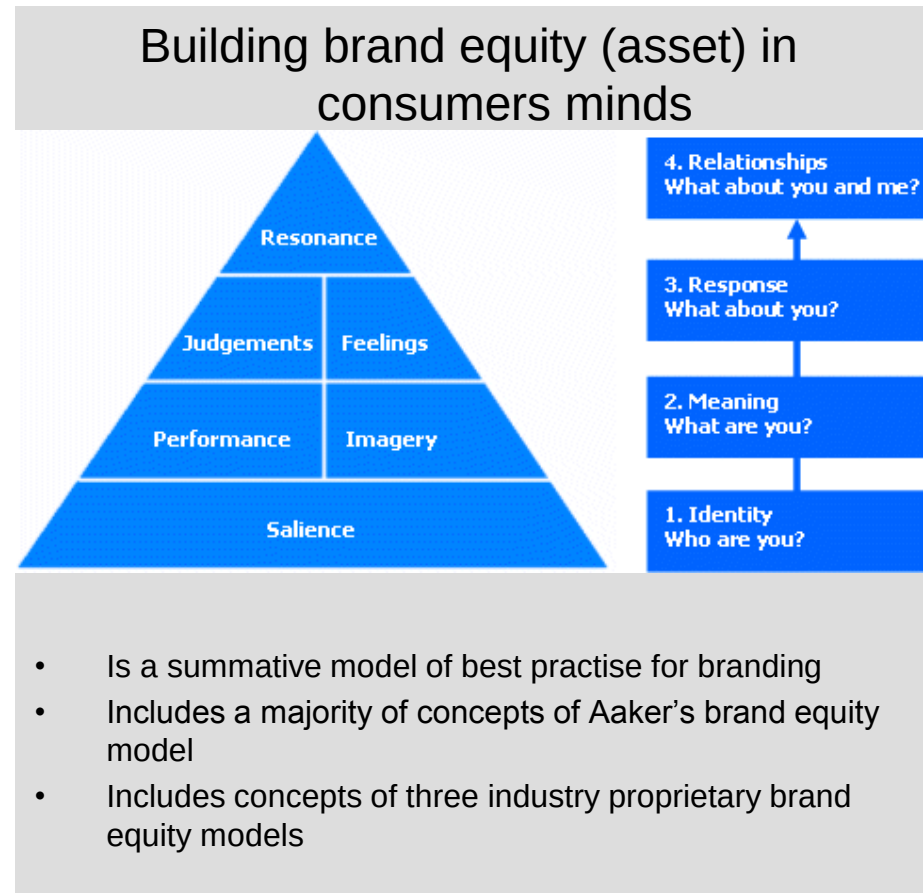


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CBBE Model

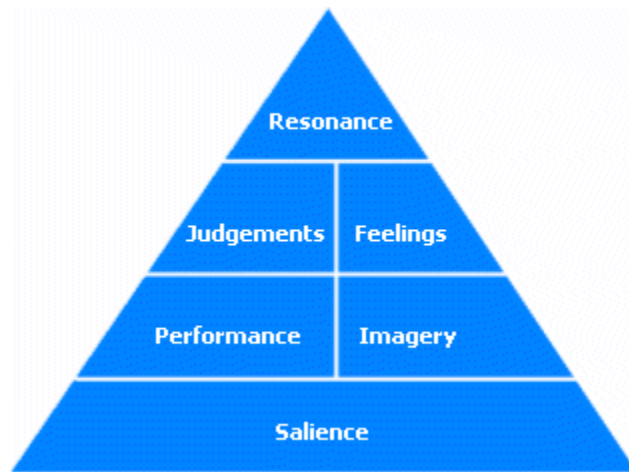


Figure 2: Keller's customer-based brand equity model

Source: Keller (2008: 60)

Questions Regarding Applicability of CBBE Model to B2B Context

- Keller claims CBBE model applicable to B2B sector, but not comprehensively validated
- Kotler and Keller (2006: 210-212) mention distinct differences between consumer and business markets
- Kuhn *et al.* (2008: 41) doubts the applicability of some of the CBBE model's building blocks for B2B context

Questions Regarding Applicability of CBBE Model to B2B Context

- CBBE model summative model of best practise for branding in consumer markets
 - B2C (FMCG) not B2B
 - Products not services
 - Individual brands not organisation brands

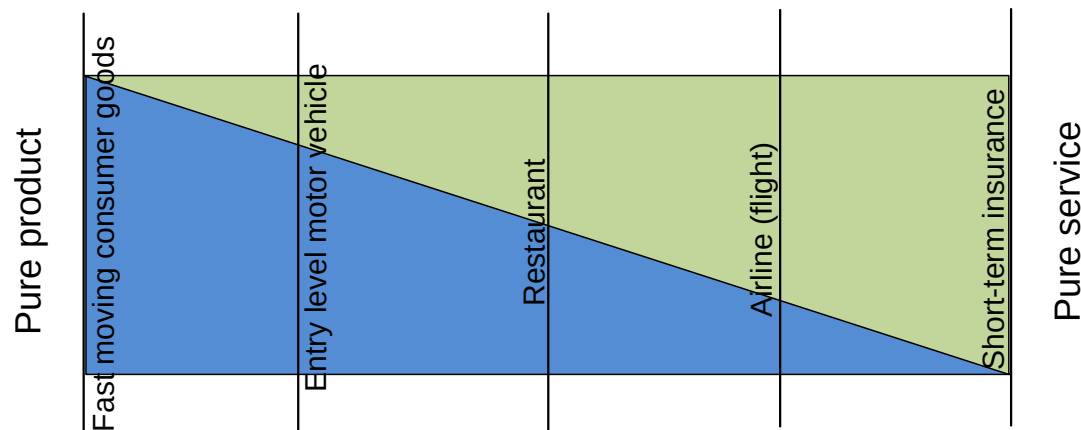


Figure 2.1: Product-service spectrum

Source: developed from Kotler & Keller, 2006: 403-404

Research Objective

- to develop a brand equity model, as strategic brand management instrument, to guide the branding process for B2B services

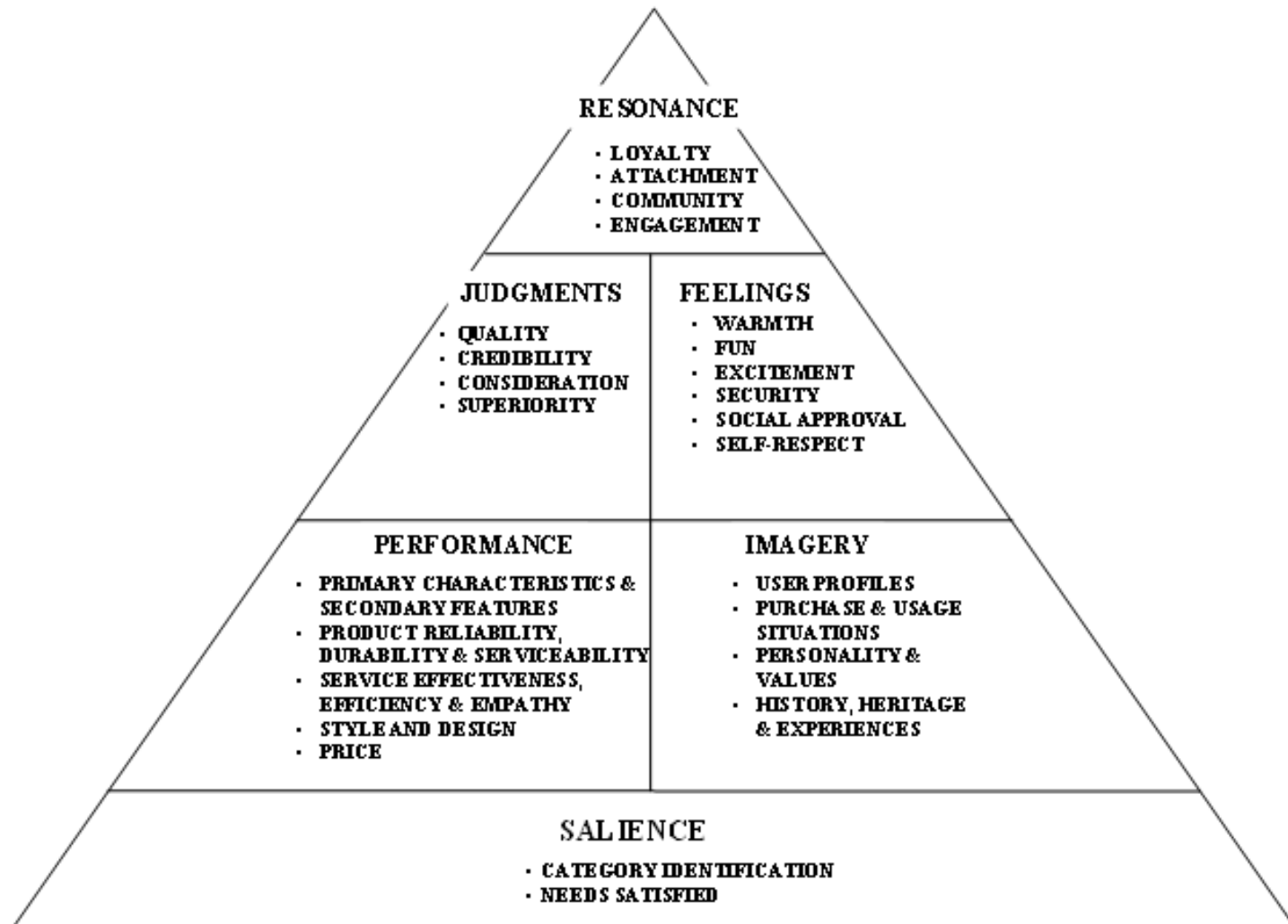
Primary Research Question

- What would constitute a brand equity model, as strategic brand management instrument, for B2B services?

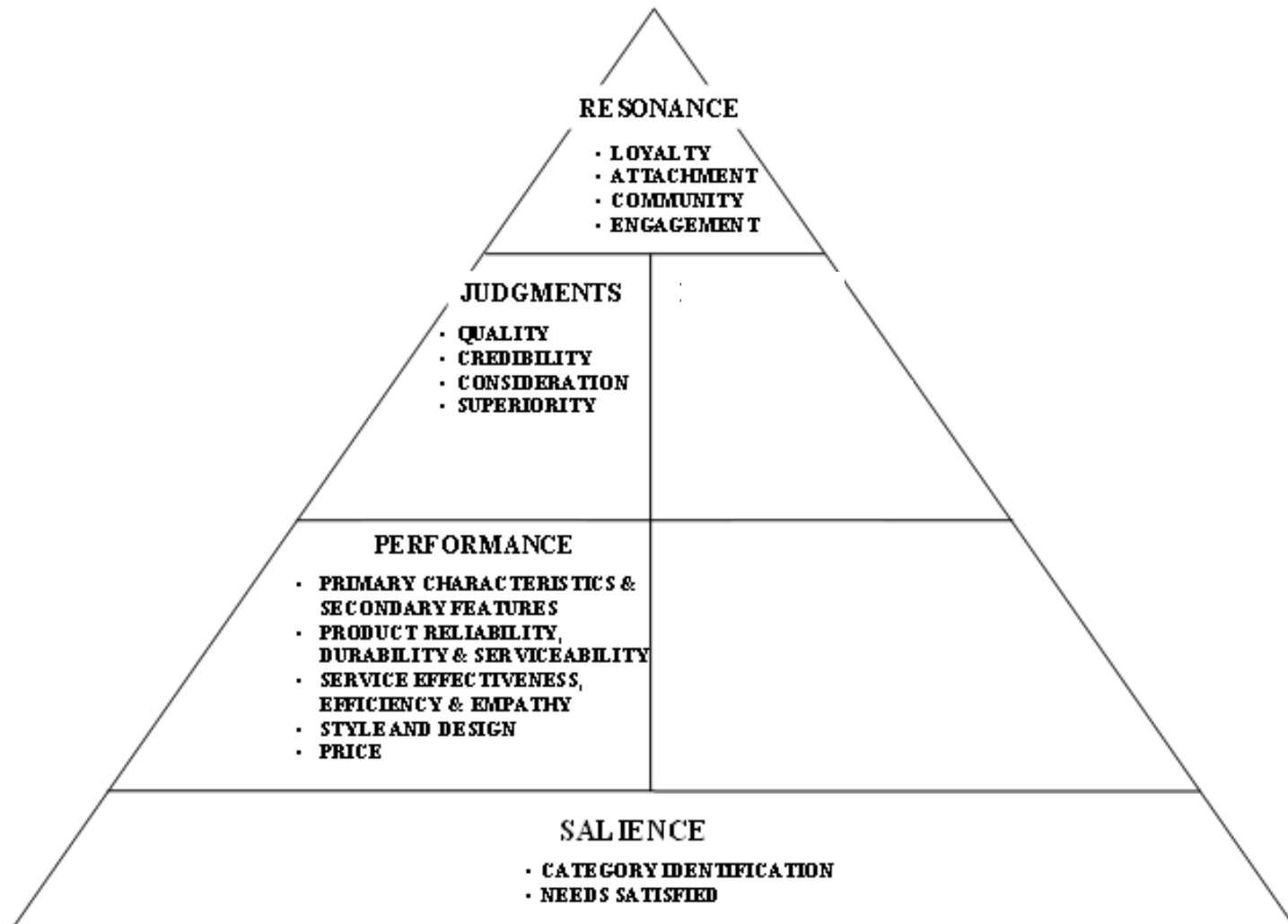
Secondary Research Questions

- Which of the brand-building blocks and sub-dimensions of the CBBE model are relevant to B2B services?
- Which of the brand-building blocks and sub-dimensions of the CBBE model are not relevant to B2B services?
- Which other brand-building blocks and sub-dimensions may be relevant to B2B services?

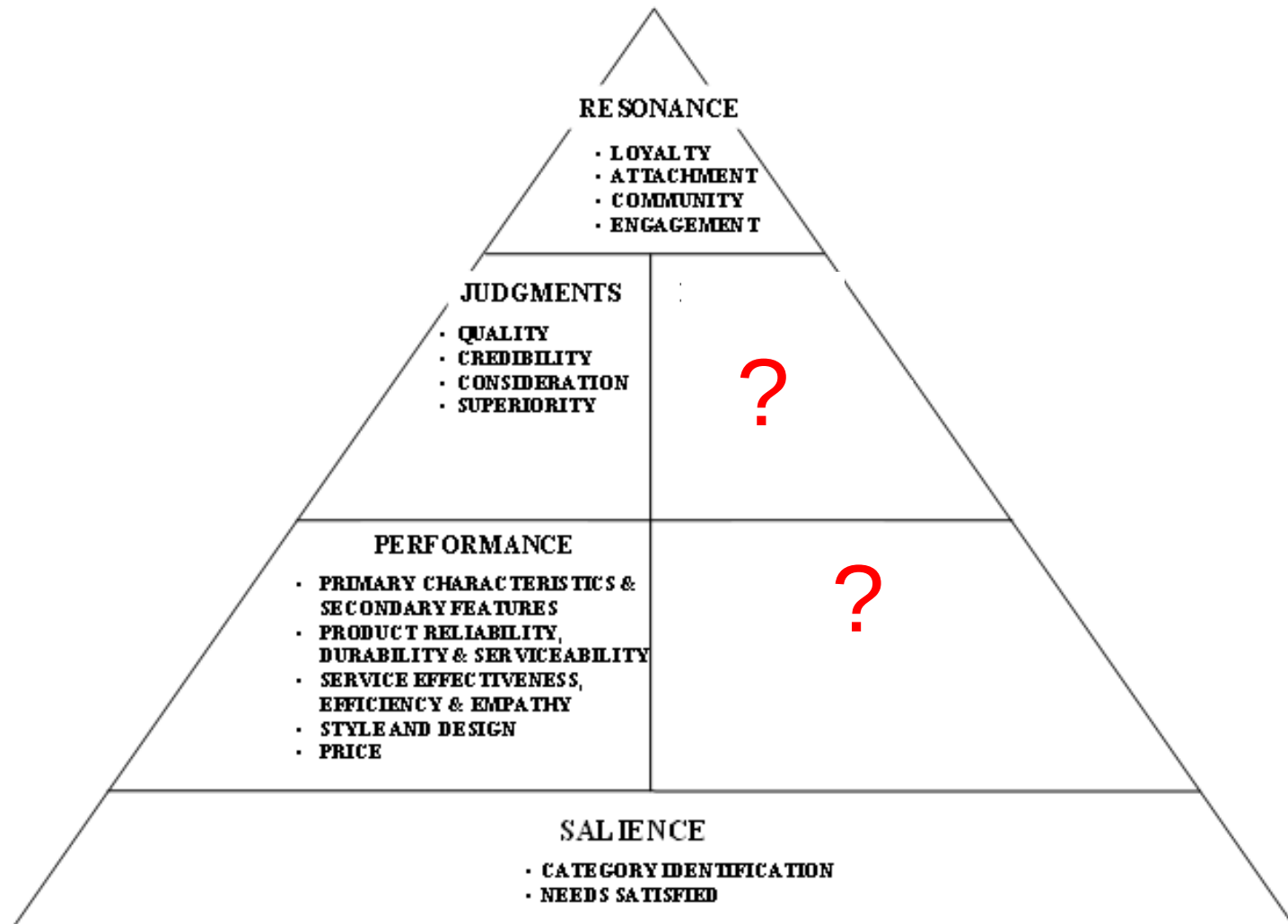
From B2C: CBBE to B2B: CL-BBE Model



From B2C: CBBE to B2B: CL-BBE Model



From B2C: CBBE to B2B: CL-BBE Model



Other Research Questions

- Are the brand-building blocks and sub-dimensions of brand equity any different for an owner-buyer to that of a professional (employee) buyer?
- Which conclusions can be drawn and which guidelines can be suggested to improve strategic brand management for B2B services?

Delimitation of Research

- The short-term insurance services industry
- Organisations located within Cape Town Metropole, South Africa
- B2B service demand-side client organisations of insurance service providers
- Owner-buyer (small) and professional buyer (medium-sized) businesses

Research Design and Methods

Pilot & Study 1

Study 2

Conceptualisation

Research design: Exploratory

Research philosophy: Empirical applied research:
Interpretivist approach

Research discourse: Induction (theory building)

Research tactic: Basic qualitative & sample survey:
cross sectional research

Data collection

Research technique In-depth interviews

Sampling

Sampling design Non-probability sampling

Sampling technique Convenience random

Instrument Questionnaire: open-ended and
structured questions

Research Design and Methods

Pilot & Study 1

Study 2

Conceptualisation

Research design:

Descriptive

Research philosophy:

Empirical applied research: Positivistic approach

Research discourse:

Deduction (theory testing)

Research tactic:

Cross sectional (sample survey)

Data collection

Research technique

Face-to-face interviews

Sampling

Sampling design

Probability sampling

Sampling technique

Simple random

Instrument

Questionnaire: structured questions

Research Design and Methods

Pilot & Study 1

Study 2

Conceptualisation

Research design:	Exploratory	Descriptive
Research philosophy:	Empirical applied research: Interpretivist approach	Empirical applied research: Positivistic approach
Research discourse:	Induction (theory building)	Deduction (theory testing)
Research tactic:	Basic qualitative & sample survey: cross sectional research	Cross sectional (sample survey)

Data collection

Research technique	In-depth interviews	Face-to-face interviews
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Sampling

Sampling design	Non-probability sampling	Probability sampling
Sampling technique	Convenience random	Simple random
Instrument	Questionnaire: open-ended and structured questions	Questionnaire: structured questions

Sampling

- **Population** – small and medium-sized B2B organisations within Cape Town Metropole, South Africa
- **Sample unit** - each organisation in sample frame
- **Sample frame** - organisation contact list
- **Sample size** – Study 1 = ? Study 2 = ?
(350 for a population of 1500 and a sample size of 400 for a population size exceeding 5000)
- **Sample element** - person in organisation responsible for short-term business insurance purchase decision e.g. purchaser, general manager, financial manager, director, CEO or MD

Methods of Analysis and Ethics

- Qualitative: thematic coding/ indexing
- Quantitative: descriptive statistics
- All ethical requirements of the USB will be adhered to e.g informed consent etc.

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